

The Product Development Factory_

What AI changes about how we build

Orchestration and enablement have always been product's real work. When execution gets cheap, **that becomes the whole job**. The receipts, the references, and what to try Monday.

Tools adopted is not work redesigned

99%

- **Ramp hit 99% AI-tool adoption.** Most people were still stuck, using the models like a faster autocomplete.
- "Driving a Ferrari with the **handbrake on.**"
- **The teams pulling away didn't buy different AI.** They changed the shape of the work.
- The whole shift is that gap. **Tools adopted vs. work redesigned.**

Close the loop

- **One system.** Ideate, prioritize, execute, evaluate, iterate.
- **Today it's a pipeline.** Hand-offs between roles, weeks between stages.
- **The shift isn't "go faster."** It's closing the loop so it turns in days, not quarters.
- **First-principles question.** Not "how do we go faster," but "is the process even shaped right."
- The human **runs the whole loop**, not one node. That's orchestration, product's real job.
- **Spec writer to strategic curator.** A background agent is the primitive you wire stages with.



Quality went *up*, not down

2×

R&D output in 9 months. 3×
at sixteen.

INTERCOM

93.6%

of pull requests agent-driven.

INTERCOM

−35%

breaking-change downtime,
deploys doubled.

INTERCOM

18×

a 231-day migration, shipped
in 13 days.

SALESFORCE

- **Quality rose after an early dip.** Salesforce posted +151% effective output, incidents down as volume rose.
- **Not a startups-only story.** Top-decile builders ~5× more productive year over year, the median up ~20%.
- The 10× tier includes **decades-old monorepos and legacy businesses**. Size and legacy aren't the disqualifier.

The asset is the shared model of the problem

```
team-os/  
  .claude/  # commands, skills  
  product/  # PRDs, customer notes  
  team/     # onboarding, retros
```

"Not rolled out until the **repository** is **updated**."

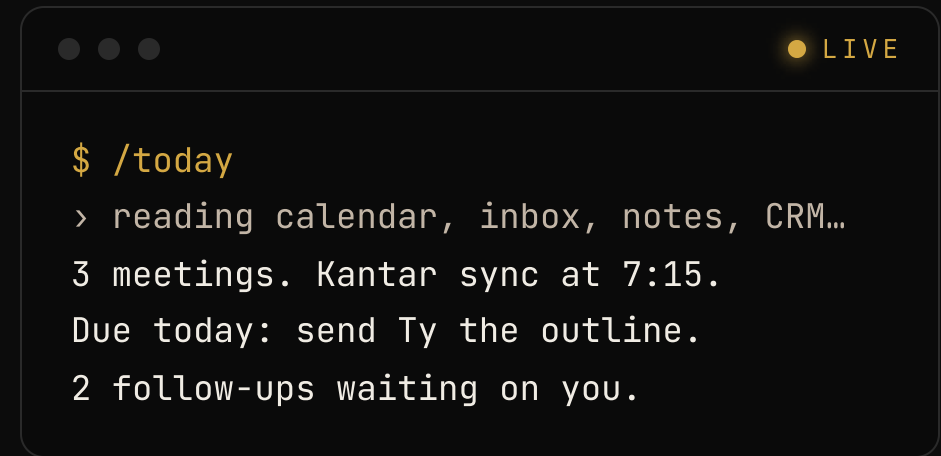
- **Individual AI use** makes one person faster. **Teams that change** share their AI infrastructure.
- **One PM supports 20** through a shared, version-controlled repo.
- Working rule, a feature isn't shipped until the repo is updated. **The system learns from every release.**
- A partner who'd **never opened GitHub** now ships daily. Shared context, not coding ability, makes the tools usable.
- The durable asset is the **model of the problem**, not the app. It's what lets you regenerate the app.

Workday prep, assembled before you walk in

- **Notion's standup pre-read agent** runs every morning. Slack, merged PRs, closed tasks, transcript, and metrics, into a shaped agenda.
- **The live demo.** One command builds my brief from calendar, email, notes, CRM. *AI synthesizes. I decide.*
- **Start as a ladder, not a leap.**

RUN IT MANUALLY → BETTER CONTEXT → BETTER TOOLS →

SCHEDULE IT
- By the end you'd call it an agent. **You got there one delegation at a time.**



```
$ /today  
> reading calendar, inbox, notes, CRM...  
3 meetings. Kantar sync at 7:15.  
Due today: send Ty the outline.  
2 follow-ups waiting on you.
```

The bottleneck moved from writing code to verifying it

1,300

agent pull requests per week.

STRIPE

423

security fixes in a month, vs a 20–30 baseline.

MOZILLA

19.2%

of PRs auto-merged, no human reviewer.

INTERCOM

- **Product doesn't write the code.** It enables the people who do, so what augmented builders can do is a product concern.
- **CI, evals, and the verification loop are the new ceiling** on throughput, and that ceiling is shared infrastructure to orchestrate.
- The unit of execution shrinks, **scrum team toward 1–3 person pods**. PM and engineer days converge. Ownership stays distinct.

The task may change. The people *don't*. Ownership doesn't move.

- **If anyone can generate a PRD, the PRD was never the job.** The mission is unchanged. Help the team understand what to build and why.
- **Volume is free now. Taste is the bottleneck.** Judgment and taste are what concentrate.
- The AI is a **brilliant junior** who read every document but wasn't in the hallway after the leadership sync. Reading the room is still a human's job.
- **What survives and grows.** Judgment, problem framing, owning the outcome. The tasks that crowded them out are receding.

// GO DEEPER

Questions, or want any of these threads pulled further?

Seb Goddijn, Ramp – 99% adoption

x.com/sebgoddijn/status/2042285915435937816

Ramp Labs, The MAD Podcast – the factory

youtube.com/watch?v=Fgzs4FBmRYw

Darragh Curran, Intercom / Fin.ai

ideas.fin.ai/p/2x-nine-months-later

Srinivas Tallapragada, Salesforce Eng.

salesforce.com/news/stories/how-engineering-became-agentic

Alfred Lin, Sequoia – 5× / +20%

x.com/alfred_lin/status/2051660439667527715

Claire Vo – the 10× tier

x.com/clairevo/status/2043720461201338702

Hannah Stahlberg, "How I AI" – team OS

youtube.com/watch?v=0UArKLQ6bXA

Ryan Nystrom, Notion – pre-read + Stripe

youtube.com/watch?v=pUHA_jNwuYE

Mozilla Hacks – agentic security harness

hacks.mozilla.org/2026/05/behind-the-scenes-hardening-firefox

Aparna Dhinakaran, "How I AI" – taste

youtube.com/watch?v=DL-pUGcfrf4